



What are the primary health and safety permits required to open a restaurant that serves alcohol in Champaign, Illinois?

To open a restaurant that serves alcohol in Champaign, you need a set of core health/safety and alcohol-related permits at the city, county, and state level.^{[1] [2] [3]}

Core health and food permits

- Champaign-Urbana Public Health District annual food establishment health permit (required for any restaurant or food truck operating regularly in Champaign County).^[2]
- Plan review approval from the health district for your kitchen/layout before construction or major remodel, tied to the health permit process.^{[4] [2]}
- Passing pre-opening and ongoing health inspections to verify compliance with local food safety rules.^{[5] [2]}

Alcohol licenses

- City of Champaign business liquor license (local license required for any on-premise sale/service of alcohol such as bars and restaurants, applied for through the City's online liquor licensing portal).^{[6] [3]}
- Illinois state liquor license from the Illinois Liquor Control Commission (required at the state level to sell or serve alcoholic beverages).^{[1] [5]}
- Dram shop (liquor liability) insurance listing the City of Champaign as an additional insured, which is a condition of the city liquor license application.^[6]

Building, fire, and zoning approvals

- Zoning/location approval from the City of Champaign to confirm restaurant and alcohol use are allowed at your chosen address.^{[3] [1]}
- Building permits for any construction or interior build-out, issued by the city's building department.^{[7] [1]}
- Fire and life-safety clearance/inspection (often tied to building occupancy approval and required before opening to the public).^{[7] [5]}

Business and tax registrations

- General city or county business registration, as required for operating a business at that location.^{[5] [7]}
- State tax registration with the Illinois Department of Revenue to collect and remit sales tax on food and alcohol.^{[1] [7]}

At-a-glance table

Requirement type	Specific permit/approval	Issuer
Food health	Annual food establishment health permit; plan review	Champaign-Urbana Public Health District ^{[2] [4]}
Alcohol – city	Business liquor license	City of Champaign (Liquor Commissioner) ^{[6] [3]}
Alcohol – state	State liquor license	Illinois Liquor Control Commission ^{[1] [5]}
Insurance	Dram shop/liquor liability insurance	Private insurer; proof filed with city ^[6]
Premises	Zoning approval, occupancy, fire/building sign-off	City of Champaign ^{[1] [7] [3]}
Business/tax	Business registration, state tax registration	City/county; Illinois Department of Revenue ^{[1] [7]}

If you'd like, I can turn this into a step-by-step checklist tailored to your exact concept (bar-heavy vs. food-heavy, live music, outdoor seating, etc.).



1. <https://www.tryotter.com/resource/wiki/licenses-and-permits-to-open-a-restaurant-in-illinois>
2. <https://www.c-uphd.org/food-safety.html>
3. <https://champaignil.gov/liquor-commissioner/liquor-licenses/>
4. https://www.c-uphd.org/documents/eh/food_service_permit_application_cu.pdf
5. <https://www.foodhandlersguide.com/food-and-beverage/restaurant-licensing-requirements-in-illinois/>
6. <https://champaignil.gov/liquor-commissioner/liquor-licenses/business-liquor-licenses/>
7. <https://www.restolabs.com/blog/licenses-and-permits-required-to-open-a-restaurant-in-illinois>
8. <https://scchealthdept.com/wp-content/uploads/2024/11/2025-Retail-Food-Ordinance-1.pdf>
9. <https://www.champaignhd.com/food-licensing>
10. <https://champaignil.gov/liquor-commissioner/liquor-licenses/temporary-liquor-licenses/>